

CHAPTER 3: THE RISE OF MARATHAS

Complete Revision Notes & NCERT Integrated Administrative & Taxation System

1. WHO ARE MARATHAS?

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Origin & Region

A group of people native to Deccan region. Controlled most of Maharashtra.

Language & Heritage

Known for their language **Marathi**. Rich literary history since 12th Century CE.

Bhakti Movement

Significant contribution to Bhakti movement in Maharashtra (e.g., Sant Ramdas).

History of Rule

Ruled by Yadavas in 13th–14th Century CE. Later, Khiljis defeated the Yadavas.

IMP TERM **Jagir:** A piece of land given to an official by a king. The official could collect taxes from it & maintain an army.

2. CHHATRAPATI SHIVAJI MAHARAJ: EARLY LIFE & MILITARY TACTICS

SHIVAJI: EARLY LIFE

Birth & Lineage

- Born in 1630 in the Bhonsle clan at Shivneri.
- **Father:** Shahaji Bhonsle (Official under Deccan Sultans, stayed away from home).
- **Mother:** Jijabai (Raised Shivaji in Pune under surveillance).

Early Campaigns & Vision

- Grew up watching people suffer due to constant conflicts.
- Dreamed of **Swarajya** (self-rule).
- Conducted his 1st military campaign at the age of 16.

IMP TERM **Guerilla Warfare:** Use of small groups of people to attack, with focus on terrain, surprise, and hit-and-run tactics (used extensively by Marathas).

3. MARITIME SUPREMACY & REGIONAL DYNAMICS

MARITIME SUPREMACY



Naval Power & Trade

- Captured the west coast & gained access to the ocean.
- Established a full-time Navy — a huge leap forward!
- Gave Marathas a first-mover advantage & monopoly in trade.
- Even Mughals did not have a full-time Navy.

Consolidation of Pune

- Shivaji's campaigns consolidated control over Pune.
- Bijapuri Sultanate did not have a full-time navy to counter.

FACT: Deccan Sultanate ultimately broke away to form 5 different states: Golconda, Bijapur, Ahmednagar, Bidar, & Berar.

4. MAJOR MILITARY ENCOUNTERS

1. Afzal Khan (Bijapur)

Bijapuri Sultan sent veteran general Afzal Khan to kill Shivaji. Shivaji met him at Pratapgarh fort and killed him using **Wagh-nak** (Tiger's claw).

2. Shaista Khan (Mughal)

Shaista Khan invaded Maratha territories for 3 years. Shivaji retaliated with a night attack; Shaista Khan lost his fingers and fled.

3. Raja Jai Singh (Mughal)

Attacked under Mughal orders. Convinced Shivaji to visit Mughal court. Shivaji was house-arrested in Agra but escaped cleverly with his son.

FACT: Jai Singh's attack was retaliation after Shivaji's 3-year wave of attacks & plunder of the wealthy port city of Surat (Marathas did not attack religious places or innocents). These attacks appeared in the *London Gazette*!

5. CORONATION (1674) & VISION

1674 CORONATION



Coronated with Vedic rituals at Raigad.

Official title: "**Shri Raja Shiva Chhatrapati**"

Started his own calendar era: "**Rajyabhishekha Shaka**"

Shivaji's Vision & Cultural Policy

- **Rajya-vyavahara Kosha:** Prepared a dictionary replacing Persian words with Sanskrit administrative terms.

Dakshina Digvijaya & Legacy

- Conquest of the South (Tamil Nadu & Karnataka).
- Poet Bhushan wrote famous poems about him.

- Wanted **Swaraj** (self-rule) and engraved this vision on his official seals.
- Devout Hindu who upheld his religion while respecting all other faiths.

- Compared to Alexander for his military brilliance.
- Passed away due to fever, leaving an enduring legacy.

6. MARATHAS AFTER SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

Chhatrapati Sambhaji

Major obstacle to Mughal control in Deccan. Aurangzeb captured, tortured, and killed him after invading Bijapur & Golconda.

Rajaram Maharaj

Fled to Gingee Fort (Tamil Nadu) and continued resistance. Drained Mughal treasury, leading to the decline of Mughals.

Maharani Tarabai

Led Marathas against Mughals and captured large northern territories. Known for brave military genius.

KEY RULER **Ahilya Bai Holkar:** Scion of Holkar dynasty (Indore). Restored temples & ghats at Kashi, Kedarnath, Somnath, & Rameshwaram.

7. MARATHA ADMINISTRATION & TAXATION SYSTEM (NCERT COMPLIANT)

A. Administrative System

- **Centralized to Decentralized:** Shivaji Maharaj maintained a highly centralized state. Under the Peshwas, administration became decentralized into a confederacy.
- **Ashta Pradhan Council (8 Ministers):**
 - *Peshwa*: Prime Minister & Finance.
 - *Senapati (Sar-i-Naubat)*: Military Commander.
 - *Amatya*: Accountant General.
 - *Sachiv*: Royal Correspondence.
 - *Waqia-Navis/Mantri*: Intelligence & Home.
 - *Sumant*: Foreign Affairs.
 - *Panditrao*: Religious Affairs.
 - *Nyayadhis*: Justice.
- **Salary & Army Reforms:** Shivaji abolished the Jagir system and paid soldiers in cash directly from the treasury.
- **Military Types:** Two types of cavalry: *Bargirs* (state-equipped) and *Shiledars* (self-equipped).
- **Judicial System:** Death penalty was rare. Local disputes settled by *Panchayats*.

B. NCERT Taxation System

- **Chauth (25% or 1/4th):**
 - Levied on neighbouring non-Maratha territories (Mughal/Sultanate lands).
 - Paid by rulers in exchange for protection against Maratha raids.
- **Sardeshmukhi (10% or 1/10th):**
 - An additional 10% levy on land revenue collected over Chauth.
 - Claimed by Shivaji in his capacity as the chief headman (Sardeshmukh) of Maharashtra.
- **Land Revenue in Swarajya:**
 - Direct settlement with cultivators (Ryots).
 - Assessed using a standard rod called *Kathi*. Revenue fixed between 33% to 40% based on actual yield.

8. MARATHAS IN THANJAVUR (SOUTH INDIA)

THANJAVUR MARATHAS



Ekoji (Venkoji)

Half-brother of Shivaji Maharaj who captured Thanjavur in late 17th Century, establishing Maratha rule in the South.

Serfoji II

Most prominent ruler. Scholar fluent in multiple languages. Created Marathi play *Devendra Kuravanji*, developed Carnatic music, Bharatanatyam, and built **Saraswathi Mahal Library**.